

Product Design Report – Pop Culture Prediction & Sentiment Platform

1. Overview

This document defines the product vision, scope, feature set, and user experience for a mobile-first pop culture platform that fuses fan communities with structured predictions, sentiment dashboards, and context cards for movies, TV, and celebrity culture. The focus audience is Gen Z and younger Millennials, who are heavy daily users of social media and entertainment apps and already juggle multiple platforms for different purposes.^{[1][2][3]}

The key differentiator from existing social media and news products is that users do not just consume headlines or post generic content. Instead, they **predict outcomes, track fandom sentiment over time, and add contextual notes distinguishing official news from rumors and fan theories.**

2. Market and User Insights

2.1 Target Audience

- **Gen Z (approx. 10–25)** and **younger Millennials (approx. 26–35)** who are highly active on short-form and video-first platforms (TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts) and spend several hours per day on social media.^{[4][3][1]}
- They use different apps for different purposes: YouTube for long-form, TikTok and Reels for trends and memes, Snapchat for close friends, Reddit/Discord for deeper communities.^{[5][3]}

2.2 Pain Points with Existing Platforms

- **News apps** (e.g., mainstream pop culture feeds) are broad, text-heavy and largely one-way consumption, with limited structured community interaction beyond comments.^{[6][7][8]}
- **Reddit/Discord** offer deep communities but can feel chaotic, long-threaded, and unstructured for quick “what’s happening + where does the fandom stand?” checks.^[3]
- **Instagram/X/TikTok** excel at trends and memes but treat pop culture as content units in a general-purpose feed, without a clean per-title/per-issue sentiment view or track-record for predictions.^{[2][1][3]}

The opportunity is a **single-purpose app where fans can follow universes, get bite-sized updates, see what the crowd thinks, and build status by being accurate and insightful.**

3. Product Vision and Positioning

3.1 Vision Statement

"A prediction- and sentiment-first social platform where pop culture fans don't just scroll news — they call outcomes, measure hype, and add context to the stories they care about."

3.2 Unique Value Proposition

- **Prediction core:** Every major news moment and long-running issue has structured predictions attached (box office, ratings, renewals, awards, character outcomes).
- **Sentiment dashboards:** Each title/franchise and hot topic has a living "fandom pulse" view: hype, satisfaction, controversy, and change over time.
- **Context cards:** Community-vetted notes clarify what is official vs rumor vs misinterpreted, borrowing from research-backed community-fact-checking patterns but adapted to entertainment.[^5][^3]
- **Status from insight, not followers:** Reputation is based on prediction accuracy, helpful context, and quality participation, not raw follower counts.

3.3 Competitive Landscape (High-Level)

- **Pop culture news apps** (e.g., People, fan magazines): strong editorial but limited structured community features or predictions.[^7][^8][^6]
- **General social platforms (Instagram, TikTok, X):** massive reach and trend discovery, but shallow or noisy for nuanced debates and long-term sentiment tracking.[^1][^2]
- **Reddit, fan forums, Discord:** strong niche communities and UGC, but low structure; sentiment and predictions are hidden in long comment threads.[^3]

This product deliberately narrows scope to **pop culture + structured decision-making**, rather than competing on pure feed engagement.

4. Core Concepts and Entities

4.1 Universe / Franchise

- Represents a major IP or world: Marvel Cinematic Universe, Stranger Things, a major anime, a K-drama universe, or a Bollywood/Hollywood franchise.
- Attributes: name, type (movie, TV, mixed), primary language(s), region tags, canonical platforms (Netflix, theaters, etc.).

4.2 Title / Season / Episode

- Concrete watchable units nested under a Universe.
- Attributes: release date(s), synopsis, poster art, cast list, tags (genre, rating, certification, runtime), status (announced, in production, released, ended).

4.3 Moment (News Card)

- Atom of the main feed: short, punchy, fact-anchored items.
- Types:
 - Official news (confirmations, release dates, trailers, casting announcements).
 - Industry moves (studio deals, strike impacts, platform shifts).
 - Rumors/leaks (clearly labeled and separated).
 - Fan theories / editorial takes.
- Fields: title, summary, time, source URL(s), source type (studio, trade, gossip, user), associated Universe/Title.

4.4 Issue Hub (Debate / Long-Running Topic)

- A structured page focused on one recurring debate or topic, e.g., "Is Franchise X suffering from fatigue?", "Was Season 8 actually bad?", "Are remakes ruining originality?".
- Contains:
 - Plain-language overview and timeline (key moments).
 - Evidence stack: official statements, interviews, box office, ratings data.
 - Sentiment panel: polls and opinion breakdowns.
 - Curated discussion threads and top takes.

4.5 Prediction

- Structured, resolvable statement attached to a Moment or Issue.
- Types:
 - Outcome (e.g., "Movie X will cross ₹200 Cr in India within 10 days of release").
 - Ratings (e.g., "Final IMDb rating will be ≥ 8.5 after 30 days").
 - Awards (e.g., "Actor Y wins Best Actor at Oscars YYYY").
 - Narrative events (e.g., "Character Z dies in Season 4 finale").
- Fields: question, options or thresholds, resolution criteria, resolution date/source, creator, participants, aggregate distribution.

4.6 Sentiment Polls

- Light-weight opinion capture elements:
 - "How hyped are you?" (Likert scale).
 - "Do you support this reboot?" (support/neutral/oppose).
 - "How satisfied were you after watching?" (post-release rating).
- Aggregators for dashboards: by time, by region, by self-declared cohort.

4.7 Context Card

- Community-sourced notes that add clarity to a claim in a Moment, Issue, or Prediction.
- Template-like structure: "What's accurate", "What's missing", "What's uncertain/speculative".
- Peer-rated for helpfulness and neutrality.

4.8 User Profile & Reputation

- Fandoms (Universes) followed.
- Prediction track record (overall accuracy, per-franchise accuracy, streaks).
- Context contribution score (how often their notes are rated helpful).
- Roles/badges: "Analyst", "Lore Master", "Hype Leader", etc.

5. Primary User Journeys

5.1 First-Time User Onboarding

1. App intro: 2–3 screens explaining "See Moments → Predict → Track fandom pulse → Build rep."
2. Choose favorite Universes / genres and preferred language(s).
3. Land on **Today** tab with a small set of personalized Moments and a clear prompt to make the first prediction.

5.2 Daily Casual User

1. Opens app → sees **Today** tab with 5–10 top Moments across followed universes.
2. Quickly skims short summaries and swipes to vote on 1–2 predictions.
3. Opens one Issue Hub to check how hype or satisfaction is trending.
4. Optionally adds a short reaction or comments on a hot debate.

5.3 Power Predictor

1. Navigates to **Scoreboard** tab to view ranking.
2. From there, taps into "Upcoming Releases" to batch-place predictions.
3. Follows specific Prediction cards to get resolution notifications.
4. Shares profile and wins externally (deep links/social share).

5.4 Context Contributor / Lore Master

1. Enters from a Moment that has unclear or controversial info.
2. Taps "Add Context" and uses structured form to add sources and explanation.
3. Sees context rated by other users and climbs context leaderboard.

6. Core Features (MVP)

6.1 Home Tabs

- **Today**
 - Mixed feed of top Moments from followed Universes and trending Issues.
 - For each card: summary, tags, tiny sentiment snippet, one-tap prediction widget.
- **Debates**
 - List of Issue Hubs sorted by activity, polarization, or recent change.

- **Scoreboard**
 - Global and per-franchise leaderboards for predictors and context contributors.

6.2 Moments Feed & Cards

- Infinite scroll of Moments, optimized for mobile, with:
 - Short headline and 2–3 line summary.
 - Pill tags (Universe, Title, type: Official/Rumor/Take).
 - Visual indicator if a Context Card exists.
 - Expanding section for sources and links.

6.3 Prediction Engine (MVP scope)

- Limited but clear set of prediction types:
 - Binary: Yes/No outcomes.
 - Threshold: Above/Below (e.g., rating thresholds, box office bands).
- Participation:
 - One prediction per user per question.
 - Simple “confidence” option (e.g., low/medium/high) that can later affect scoring.
- Scoring model (MVP):
 - Award base points for correct calls, with small bonus for minority correct positions.

6.4 Sentiment Dashboards

- Per-Issue and per-Title views:
 - Pie/stack for current support/hype/satisfaction distribution.
 - Simple trend line over recent weeks.
 - Filters: all users vs region; possibly by age band later.

6.5 Context Cards (Limited Beta)

- Restricted to pre-selected or reputation-gated users in early phases.
- Displayed as inline expandable notes under Moments or Issues.
- Other users can rate each note “Helpful / Not helpful / Biased”, feeding reputation.

6.6 Profiles & Reputation

- Basic profile view:
 - Username, avatar, short bio.
 - Top fandoms.
 - Summary stats: predictions attempted, accuracy, context notes approved.
- Leaderboards viewable by all, but social graph (following/followers) can come later.

7. Future Feature Roadmap (Beyond MVP)

- **Community hubs** for each Universe (sub-forums, fan art, memes) with guardrails to prevent generic feed bloat.
- **Full review system** (short capsule reviews and rating distribution per Title).
- **Deeper analytics** for fandoms: cross-franchise overlap, “fandom migration” across seasons.
- **Creator/critic tools**: verified critics or YouTubers can attach long-form explainers directly to Issue Hubs.
- **Monetization experiments**:
 - Non-intrusive in-feed sponsorships aligned with specific franchises.
 - Premium analytics or advanced stats for super-fans.

8. Success Metrics (Initial)

- Activation:
 - % of new users who place at least 1 prediction on day 1.
- Engagement:
 - Daily/weekly active users.
 - Predictions per DAU and polls answered per DAU.
 - Issue views and time spent per session.
- Retention:
 - D1, D7, D30 retention.
- Quality:
 - % of Moments with at least one Context Card.
 - User ratings of helpfulness on context cards.

9. Design Principles for UI/UX

- **Signal over noise**: Surfaces should favor structured interactions (predict/vote/context) over long comment rabbit holes.
- **Fandom-first theming**: Visuals and micro-animations themed around fandom and “calling it first” rather than generic social icons.
- **One-hand casual**: Critical actions (predict, vote, open Issue) accessible within thumb reach; optimized for short sessions.
- **Explainability**: Tooltips and microcopy explain prediction resolution criteria and sentiment charts in simple language.

This document should be used by design, product, and engineering to write detailed user stories, screens, and data schemas for implementation.

References

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